U.S. UTILITY PATENT FILING CHECKLIST - REVISED

Core filing documents

Specification, claims, and abstract in DOCX.

Patent drawings, when necessary, in compliant black-and-white form.

Current USPTO Application Data Sheet (official form / Patent Center).

Current USPTO inventor oath or declaration.

Required filing, search, and examination fees or appropriate fee status.

Pre-filing technical checks

Inventorship verified.

Applicant / assignee and ownership chain verified.

Priority and foreign-filing data verified.

Government funding / government-interest status verified.

Public disclosure history reviewed.

All claim terminology supported in the specification.

Every claimed feature that requires drawing support appears in the redrafted drawings.

Unverified dimensions and other generated artwork artifacts removed from the substantive disclosure.

Current submission note

USPTO currently supports DOCX filing for the specification/claims/abstract, and the 2026 process update uses direct DOCX-to-TIFF pre-submission conversion in Patent Center. Applicants should review the generated validation output before filing.

Post-filing

Save filing receipt and application number. Track prosecution deadlines. Update IDS as appropriate. Review continuation/divisional strategy with patent counsel.